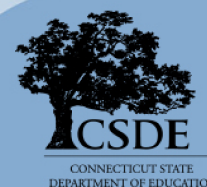


DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2020–21

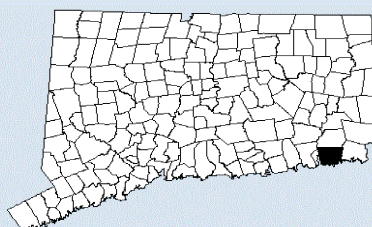


Groton School District

860-572-2100 • <https://www.grotonschools.org/>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	11
Enrollment	4,068
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$17,068
Total Expenditures ¹	\$80,458,371

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2019-20 school year.

Community Information

[AdvanceCT Town Profiles](#) provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2020-21 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality, or to ensure that statistics based on a very small sample size are not interpreted as equally representative as those based on a sufficiently larger sample size.

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2020 Enrollment²

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
Female	1,951	48.0	48.4
Male	2,117	52.0	51.5
American Indian or Alaska Native	39	1.0	0.3
Asian	255	6.3	5.2
Black or African American	303	7.4	12.7
Hispanic or Latino of any race	938	23.1	27.8
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	20	0.5	0.1
Two or More Races	435	10.7	4.0
White	2,078	51.1	49.9
English Learners	147	3.6	8.3
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	2,182	53.6	42.7
Students with Disabilities ³	766	18.8	16.3

NOTE: To protect student privacy, gender counts are suppressed (*) when fewer than 6 students enrolled in the district identify as non-binary.

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	663	36.2	20	1.0
Male	762	38.8	36	1.6
Black or African American	143	50.2	14	4.1
Hispanic or Latino of any race	466	52.3	16	1.6
White	560	29.3	18	0.8
English Learners	73	48.7	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	981	50.4	48	2.2
Students with Disabilities	337	48.1	22	2.4
District	1,425	37.5	56	1.3
State		19.0		1.4

Number of students in 2019-20 qualified as truant under state statute: 300

Number of school-based arrests: 0

NOTE: In the 2020-21 school year, students attended school in-person to varying degrees; some learned fully/mostly remotely for the entire school year. Chronic absenteeism calculations are based only on in-person school days.

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Groton School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	284.8
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	39.9
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	61.5
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	191.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	6.0
School Level	27.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	8.5
Support Staff	2.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	29.1
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	32.6
School Nurses	10.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	253.5

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	1	0.2	0.1
Asian	7	1.6	1.3
Black or African American	20	4.4	4.1
Hispanic or Latino of any race	9	2.0	4.3
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	1	0.2	0.1
White	413	91.6	89.9

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2019-20

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	7.3	7.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	11	*	22	66.7
Hispanic or Latino of any race	29	63.0	39	84.8
White	113	81.9	117	90.7
English Learners	*	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	65	65.0	86	84.3
Students with Disabilities	16	48.5	34	65.4
District	180	73.5	216	87.1
State		75.9		85.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual enrollment courses.

Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	48	47.1
Emotional Disturbance	33	46.5
Intellectual Disability	8	27.6
Learning Disability	230	93.5
Other Health Impairment	82	72.6
Other Disabilities	10	29.4
Speech/Language Impairment	78	94.0
District	489	72.1
State		67.9

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Groton School District

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	107	2.5	2.1
Emotional Disturbance	71	1.7	1.1
Intellectual Disability	29	0.7	0.5
Learning Disability	250	5.8	5.8
Other Health Impairment	115	2.7	3.3
Other Disabilities	86	2.0	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	94	2.2	1.9
All Disabilities	752	17.6	15.9

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	56	7.4	8.3
Private Schools or Other Settings	32	4.3	4.8

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2019-20

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$48,858,547	\$10,365	\$11,205
Support services - students	\$9,846,716	\$2,316	\$1,346
Support services - instruction	\$1,712,836	\$403	\$698
Support services - general administration	\$1,819,082	\$428	\$464
Support services - school based administration	\$4,563,816	\$1,073	\$1,037
Central and other support services	\$1,800,336	\$423	\$691
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$6,521,579	\$1,534	\$1,692
Student transportation services	\$5,335,459	\$1,557	\$1,159
Food services	.	.	\$21
Enterprise operations	.	.	\$151
Total	\$80,458,371	\$17,068	\$17,838

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2019-20

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$8,209,115	36.7	29.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$3,507,407	15.7	11.1
Other Salaries	\$1,191,388	5.3	9.5
Employee Benefits	\$2,019,950	9.0	13.5
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$1,527,826	6.8	5.4
Special Education Tuition	\$4,127,587	18.5	22.5
Supplies	\$99,318	0.4	0.5
Property Services	\$1,808	0.0	0.3
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$1,616,641	7.2	7.2
Equipment	\$55,274	0.2	0.2
All Other Expenditures	\$1,360	0.0	0.1
Total	\$22,357,675	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		27.8	25.1

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2019-20

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	63.5
State	33.6
Federal	2.8
Tuition & Other	0.1

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Groton School District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

READING	NAEP 2019		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	40	41	50
National Public	34	32	36
MATH	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	45	39	32
National Public	40	33	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2019.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Groton School District

Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2019-20	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	15	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	49	81.6
English Learners	7	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	126	80.2
Students with Disabilities	41	70.7
District	245	88.2
State		88.8

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2019-20 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Meeting Benchmark on at Least One College Readiness Exam³

	Participation ⁴	Meeting Benchmark	
	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	82.3	86	39.1
Male	74.4	86	31.5
Black or African American	57.7	6	11.5
Hispanic or Latino	66.3	13	14.1
White	83.5	128	47.9
English Learners	*	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	68.3	24	11.9
Students with Disabilities	50.6	*	*
District	77.9	172	34.9
State	85.0		36.0

³College readiness exams and benchmark scores are as follows:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam

⁴Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

Copyright © 2021 ACT, Inc. www.act.org

IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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* The data are suppressed to ensure confidentiality.

College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2020	Class of 2019
	Entrance ³	Persistence ⁴
	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Female	67.2	90.4
Male	51.8	81.6
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	45.5	79.3
White	63.1	90.2
English Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	50.0	76.6
Students with Disabilities	32.4	*
District	59.6	86.2
State	67.4	84.9

³ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁴ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Groton School District

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, a modified table is shown below. All indicators that were not calculated for the 2020-21 school year (including overall Accountability Index) have been excluded and columns that referenced points have also been removed to avoid confusion. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	State Average Index/Rate
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	37.5%	<=5%	19.0%
	High Needs Students	47.5%	<=5%	30.2%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	80.3%	75%	80.6%
	% Passing Exams	34.9%	75%	36.0%
On-track to High School Graduation		84.7%	94%	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2020 Cohort)		88.2%	94%	88.8%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2018 Cohort)		80.1%	94%	85.2%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2020)		59.6%	75%	67.4%
Arts Access		64.0%	60%	50.7%

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	80.1%	13.9%	9.8%	Y

¹ If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

² If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no SIMR data are available. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Supporting Resources:

Two-page FAQ at http://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/nextgenFAQ_revisedDec2018.pdf

Detailed Presentation at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Next%20Generation%20Accountability%20System_Detailed%20Presentation_Jan_2020.pdf

Using Accountability Results to Guide Improvement at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Using_Accountability_Results_to_Guide_Improvement.pdf

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Groton School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Groton Public Schools realized the Groton 2020 plan with the opening of one new middle school, Groton Middle School, ensuring excellence, equity, and balance for all middle school students. As part of the plan with the state of Connecticut that would ensure racial and socioeconomic balance at all Groton schools, this plan also included the building of two new elementary schools on the sites of the former two middle schools. The six elementary schools prepared and planned for an all intra-district magnet option for students in Groton with the rollout of a lottery process in order to relocate students and staff from the six schools into five school for the following year. We involved parents through surveys and focus groups to share their input on the magnet schools.

Groton Public Schools continues to focus on quality instruction and student achievement, which are inherent in our district mission and goals. As a PK-12 school system, we use engaging inquiry-based instruction and a variety of formative and summative assessments as part of our yearly assessment calendar to inform curriculum and instruction aligned with the CSDE. The scheduled SBAC assessments, the NGSS, and the eleventh grade SAT exams were given in the spring of 2021; however, due to the pandemic, students in Groton had options for Hybrid or Remote Learning, with a few who participated in full in-person learning. All ninth and tenth graders take the PSAT exam; those results are used to inform instruction.

Groton Public Schools has grown teacher leadership in the areas of 6-12 Coordinators in ELA, Humanities, STEM and Special Education. At the elementary level, each school has both a literacy and math specialist. These specialists provide teacher coaching and coordinate instruction as well as provide intervention and enrichment to students. The district has also implemented this specialist model at the middle school level.

In the area of special education, the district continued its co-teaching model at both the middle and high school levels. The district continues to use the inclusion model at all grade levels and has continued its Intensive Behavioral Support Programs at the elementary, middle, and high school levels. The district's post-graduate Transition Academy is currently located at a renovated facility in the Central Office. Groton Public Schools continued its partnership with Columbia's Teacher College Reading and Writing Project, utilizing the Remote Units of study with videos from TCRWP staff developers for grades K-8. In addition, the teachers continue to work with distinguished math consultant, Dr. Cathy Fosnot, on inquiry-based math workshops.

Groton Public Schools has recently completed a major curricular initiative; the district applied for and was approved for a candidacy for the International Baccalaureate Middle Years Program in grades 6-10. This initiative is aimed at significantly expanding enrollment in the International Baccalaureate programs offered by the district, both the IB Diploma Program and IB Careers Program. The program ensures excellence and equity and promotes college and career readiness.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

Groton schools continues to work to ensure that our students receive an education which enables them to interact with teachers and students from diverse racial, ethnic, and economic backgrounds.

In the spring of 2020, the Groton Board of Education responded to the social unrest caused by the killing of George Floyd by initiating a district-wide Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Committee. The 100-person group developed a five-year program to address issues of systemic racism and to promote equity for all members of the educational community. During the 2020-2021 school year, over one hundred teachers and administrators participated in the district DEI Committee that was responsible for planning and facilitating professional learning, book clubs, data collection, policy review, and the lifting of student voice. All faculty and staff were involved in the experience, and the BOE recognized and approved the DEI vision statement for Groton Public Schools.

In Groton Public Schools, where 49% of the students are eligible for free and reduced lunch, all students were provided a school nutrition program, and the district implemented a one-to-one Chromebook initiative, with hotspots as needed, to provide computer access for all students.

Other opportunities to offer enriching and diverse experiences for our student population included student trips to the Mystic Seaport, the Mystic Aquarium, Project Oceanology, NESS, the Mystic Art Museum, the Eastern Connecticut Symphony Orchestra, the Nautilus Museum, to name a few, as well as our continued partnering with the U.S. Naval Submarine Base and use of its resources.

Fitch High School students participated remotely in a regional diversity program called More Than Words. The program engages students from New London High School, Ledyard High School and students from the Mashantucket Pequot Tribal Nation in a year-long workshop designed to promote respect for diversity and develop skills in conflict resolution.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Groton School District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

The Groton Board of Education's policy concerning the annual distribution of resources ensures that each of the seven schools in the district receives an adequate level of material, supplies, and personnel to implement and execute educational programs. Funding is based on student enrollment, district-wide educational programs, and the unique needs of its students, commensurate with district goals and available resources to ensure equity and address needs.